The People & Meetings Drain Sorter

This is possibly the most useful sheet in the pack, and it's slightly harder to be honest about than the others — because it's about people. Everyone's energy leaks somewhere around certain humans and certain meetings, and the leaks are rarely bearable to name.

The sorter isn't about judging anyone. Some people energize, some are neutral, some drain — and this can be true of genuinely wonderful people. It can even be true of people you love. Naming the pattern is how you stop being surprised by the empty feeling at 4 p.m.

1. List the people you spend time with and the meetings that recur. Guess first; refine next week.
2. Sort each into Energize / Neutral / Drain. Add a one-word "why" — the why is where the usable information lives.
3. For each Drain, pick a tiny action: shorter, later, with someone else in the room, walking instead of seated, or graced with a reschedule. Drain items don't need solving, just adjusting the dosage.

A drained calendar is not usually about busyness. More often, it's about dosage. You're not cutting people off — you're adjusting how much, and when.

Written privately, kept private. If you work in healthcare or anywhere with a roster, some drains are mandatory staffing — sort them anyway, honestly; the sheet doesn't require you to fix what you name.

People & Meetings Drain Sorter

Sort honestly, in pencil. One-word "why" per line. No fixing required today.

ENERGIZE ME	WHY	HOW TO GET MORE OF THIS

NEUTRAL (FINE, NO CHANGE)	WHY	NOTE TO SELF

DRAINS ME	WHY	ONE TINY DOSAGE CHANGE

Dosage-change examples: shorten to 20 minutes, add agenda or purpose, walk-and-talk, reschedule away from my flattest hour, ask for a recap instead of attending, cushion it with 15 quiet minutes before and after.

THE DRAIN I MOST WANT TO ADJUST FIRST	THE ENERGIZER I MOST WANT MORE OF — SCHEDULED WHERE?

Free Energy Mapping Printables · drain sorter · best rerun once a season, since people change too.